Smart Budgeting and Financial Goal Management System

Setup, Deployment & User Guide

Official project name	Smart Budgeting and Financial Goal Management System
Prepared for	Team J
Version / date	Version 1.0 | 8 October 2026

Working draft. Confirm project-specific decisions with the team and supervisor before treating this document as approved.

Part A — Developer setup checklist

Exact commands depend on the final approved stack and operating system. The checklist below avoids locking the team into unconfirmed package versions.

1. Install the approved language runtimes, package managers and PostgreSQL version.
2. Create the project repository and agree on branch naming and code review rules.
3. Create separate frontend and backend configuration files; keep secrets out of source control.
4. Create a local PostgreSQL database and a least-privilege development database user.
5. Configure database URL, secret key, allowed hosts/CORS and other settings through environment variables.
6. Install backend dependencies and create database migrations.
7. Run migrations and create fictional development/test data.
8. Start backend and frontend using the repository README commands.
9. Run automated tests and manually verify registration, transactions, budgets, goals and reports.
10. Record exact tested versions and commands in the final README.

Part B — Deployment checklist

- Use HTTPS and secure production configuration.
- Use a strong unique production secret stored in the hosting provider's secret manager/environment settings.
- Set allowed hosts, CORS and cookie/token security settings correctly.
- Use production database credentials with least privilege.
- Apply migrations through a controlled release process.
- Configure backups and test restoring a backup.
- Avoid real user data in demos, screenshots and logs.
- Set up error monitoring without recording passwords, tokens or unnecessary financial details.
- Document rollback steps and the person responsible for maintenance.

Part C — End-user quick guide

1. Create an account and sign in

Register using the approved identifier and password. Sign in to access your private dashboard.

2. Add income

Open Transactions, choose Income, enter amount/date/source category and save.

3. Add an expense

Open Transactions, choose Expense, enter amount/date/category and save.

4. Set a budget

Open Budgets, select category and period, enter a limit and save. Review the used and remaining amounts.

5. Create a savings goal

Open Savings Goals, enter a name, target amount and optional target date, then save.

6. Record goal progress

Open a goal and add a contribution. Check that the displayed total and progress update.

7. Review dashboard and reports

Select the period and compare the summaries with the records entered for that period.

8. Protect your account

Sign out on shared devices. Do not share your password. Report unexpected figures or access problems to the project team.

Part D — Known limitations for MVP

- Figures depend on the accuracy and completeness of manually entered records.
- A net cash-flow summary is not the same as a verified bank or mobile-money balance.
- Rule-based insights should explain what pattern triggered them and should not be treated as guaranteed financial advice.
- Features not explicitly approved in the SRS are not promised in the first release.